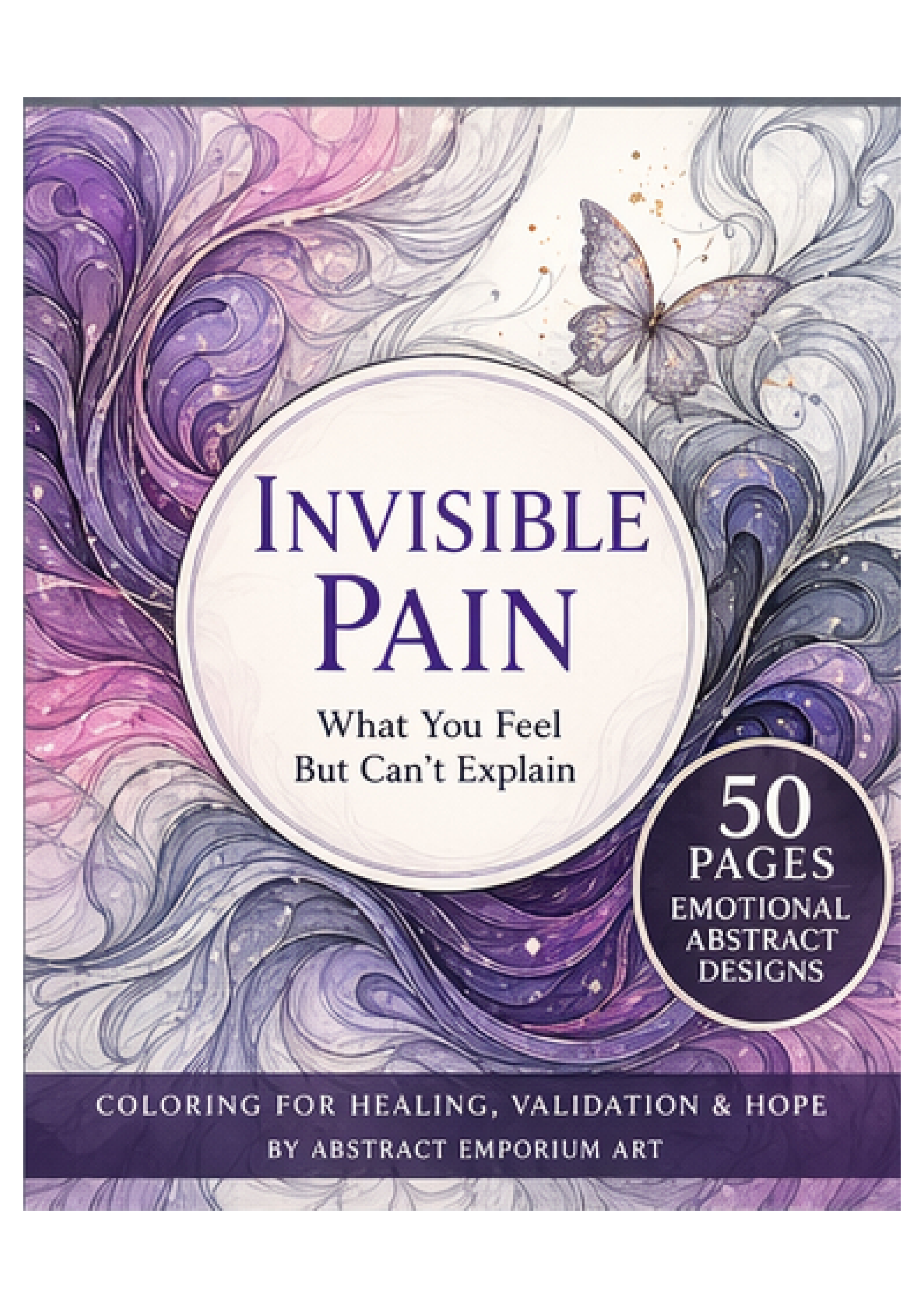




INVISIBLE PAIN

What You Feel
But Can't Explain

50
PAGES
EMOTIONAL
ABSTRACT
DESIGNS

COLORING FOR HEALING, VALIDATION & HOPE
BY ABSTRACT EMPORIUM ART



Welcome

YOU'VE TAKEN A BRAVE STEP
TOWARD YOURSELF.

This coloring book is a safe space
for what's hard to put into words.

There's no right or wrong way to use it.
There's only your way.



*You don't have to explain.
You don't have to be okay.*

Just bring whatever you're carrying...
and let color help you hold it.

You belong here.



A NOTE ON INVISIBLE PAIN

This book is for you if:

- Your pain doesn't show in X-rays or blood tests, but it's there—real, heavy, constant.
- You've heard "but you look fine" too many times.
- You're tired of explaining what can't be seen.
- You carry chronic illness, trauma, grief, invisible disability, or any kind of suffering that lives beneath the surface.



YOUR PAIN IS VALID.

Even when invisible.
Even when others don't understand.
Even when you question it yourself.

This coloring book doesn't promise to fix you. (You're not broken.)
It offers something quieter:

- A place to process without words.
- A way to honor what hurts without explanation.
- Permission to make the invisible visible—
through color, through texture, through your own hands.

Each page is an invitation:

- To witness your pain.
- To sit with it gently.
- To transform it into something you can hold and say,
"This is what it feels like."

And maybe, slowly, to find moments of healing
woven between the lines.



You don't have to be "okay" to color these pages.
Come as you are.

This space is yours.

EMOTION PALETTE SYSTEM

Color is a language for what words can't hold.
Use this guide to translate your experience onto the page.



PAIN / STRUGGLE PALETTE

When you're in it—the hard, heavy, dark places.



These colors don't fix the pain.
They honor it. They make it real.

- Deep Purples (grief, depth, the weight)
- Burgundy/Maroon (old wounds, chronic ache)
- Dark Blues (loneliness, the cold parts)
- Charcoal/Grey (numbness, fog, exhaustion)



HOPE / HEALING PALETTE

When you glimpse light—the gentle, tentative, brave places.



These colors don't erase the dark.
They coexist with it. They whisper, "Maybe."

- Soft Yellows (hope, tiny sparks)
- Gentle Pinks (self-compassion, tenderness)
- Peach/Coral (warmth returning)
- Lavender (soothing, rest, release)



STRENGTH / SURVIVAL PALETTE

When you recognize your resilience—the fierce, survivor places.



These colors celebrate the truth:
You're still here. That's power.

- Reds (fierce love, boundaries, anger that protects)
- Oranges (energy to keep going, fire within)
- Notiee tooth, value, precaninanes)
- Forest Green (grounded, still here, growing)

THE LAYERING METHOD:

You don't have to choose one palette.
Pain isn't that simple.

Try this:

1. Start with PAIN colors (where it hurts)
2. Layer HOPE colors (where you long for relief)
3. Add STRENGTH colors (where you've survived)



Let them overlap. Let them blur. That's the truth of invisible pain—
it's all of it, all at once.

Your page will reflect that complexity. And that's exactly right.

4 HEALING METHODS

These techniques are trauma-informed and gentle.
Do what feels safe. Skip what doesn't. You're in control.

1 METHOD 1: SHADOW WORK COLORING

Honor the dark before seeking the light.

How to practice:

1. Start with the darkest colors (blacks, deep purples, charcoal)
2. Color heavily—let the pressure match the weight
3. Don't avoid the "ugly" or "scary" parts
4. Gradually (only when ready) introduce one lighter color
5. Notice: The dark doesn't disappear. It becomes part of the whole.

Why this helps:

Pain demands to be witnessed before it can transform.
This isn't toxic positivity.
This is truth-telling in color.

2 METHOD 2: HIGHLIGHT HEALING

Find the moments of "okay" and make them visible.

How to practice:

1. Color most of page in medium tones (grays, muted colors)
2. Leave a few small spaces blank
3. In those spaces, use your brightest, most hopeful colors
4. These represent: moments you laughed, days pain was 6/10 instead of 9/10, tiny victories

Why this helps:

Invisible pain makes us forget the good moments exist. This practice proves: Both are real. Pain AND the breaks from pain.



3 METHOD 3: PRESSURE RELEASE

Your grip holds your story.

How to practice:

1. Notice your grip on the coloring tool
2. If holding tightly (trauma response: hypervigilance, control) → Color with that pressure. Let it out.
3. Every few minutes, consciously loosen your grip
4. Watch colors lighten as you release
5. End with barely-there strokes (practice softness)

Why this helps:

Your body holds what your mind can't process. This technique releases it through your hands.



4 METHOD 4: GRADIENT HEALING

Recovery isn't linear, but it can have direction.

How to practice:

1. Divide page into sections (top to bottom or left to right)
2. Section 1: Darkest colors (where you've been)
3. Section 2: Medium colors (where you are now)
4. Section 3: Lighter colors (where you hope to go)
5. Let colors blend at borders (the journey isn't separate stages)

Why this helps:

It externalizes progress you can't always feel. On hard days, you can look back and see: you've moved.



Remember: Healing isn't about "finishing" these pages perfectly.
It's about showing up for yourself, one color at a time.

You're doing this. That's enough.



AFFIRMATIONS FOR HARD DAYS

When words are hard to find, borrow these.
Come back when you need them.



YOUR PAIN IS VALID,
EVEN WHEN INVISIBLE.



YOU DON'T HAVE TO PROVE YOUR SUFFERING
TO DESERVE COMPASSION.



SCARS ARE PROOF YOU SURVIVED,
NOT PROOF YOU'RE BROKEN.



HEALING IS NOT LINEAR.
SOME DAYS WILL BE HARDER THAN OTHERS.
THAT DOESN'T MEAN YOU'RE FAILING.



YOU ARE ALLOWED TO REST.
YOU ARE ALLOWED TO SAY NO.
YOU ARE ALLOWED TO PROTECT YOUR PEACE.



YOUR BODY IS NOT THE ENEMY.
IT'S TRYING TO KEEP YOU SAFE
IN THE ONLY WAY IT KNOWS HOW.



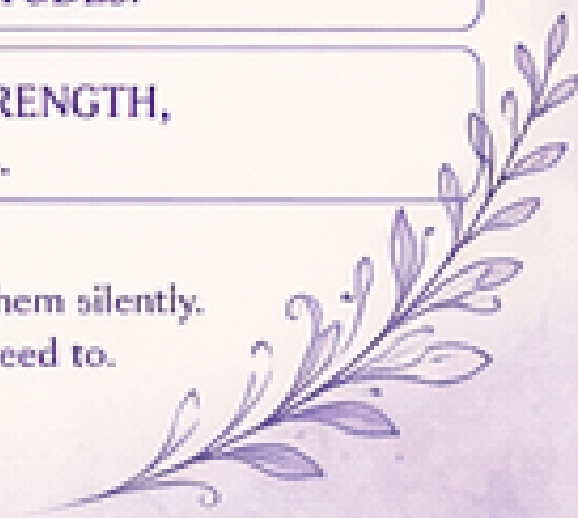
YOU ARE MORE THAN YOUR PAIN.
YOU CONTAIN MULTITUDES.



ASKING FOR HELP IS STRENGTH,
NOT WEAKNESS.



Speak these aloud, or just read them silently.
Let them land where they need to.



OPTIONAL JOURNAL PROMPTS

Coloring can be enough on its own.
But if you want to deepen the practice, try these prompts.
No pressure. No "right" answers. Even one word counts.



BEFORE YOU COLOR:

1. What does invisible pain feel like in your body today? (Tightness, heaviness, buzzing, numbness, ache...)
2. If your pain had a color, what would it be *right now*?
3. What do you need most in this moment? (Rest, validation, distraction, release, connection...)
4. On a scale of 1–10, where's your pain level today?



WHILE YOU COLOR:

5. What colors are you drawn to? Why might that be?
6. Are you coloring gently or with pressure? What does that tell you?
7. Notice your breath. Is it shallow, deep, held, flowing?
8. If this page could speak, what would it say?



AFTER YOU COLOR:

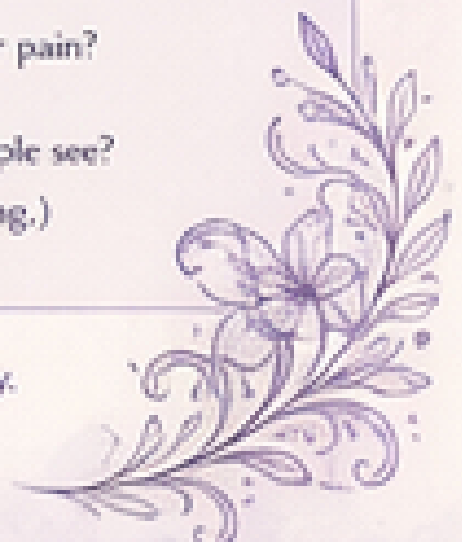
9. How does your body feel now compared to before?
10. Did anything shift? (Even tiny shifts count.)
11. What did this page help you process or release?
12. Is there anything you're grateful for right now? (Even "I'm grateful I showed up for myself" counts.)

DEEPER REFLECTION (OPTIONAL):

- What would you say to someone else experiencing your pain? Can you offer yourself that same compassion?
- If invisible pain could be made visible, what would people see?
- What does healing mean to you? (Not "cured"—healing.)



Keep these prompts nearby, or ignore them completely.
You're the expert on what you need.





GENTLE REMINDER

This coloring book is a therapeutic tool for self-expression.
It is NOT a replacement for professional mental health care.

If you're experiencing:

- Suicidal thoughts
- Self-harm urges
- Flashbacks or dissociation
- Crisis-level distress



US Crisis Resources:

- 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline: Call or text 988
- Crisis Text Line: Text HOME to 741741
- RAINN (Sexual Assault Hotline): 1-800-656-4673

International crisis lines: findahelpline.com

You deserve professional, compasisonate support. This book can be part of your healing toolkit, but it's not meant to replace therapy or medical care.



HOW TO USE THIS BOOK



COLORING TOOLS:

Works with colored pencils, markers, gel pens, crayons, or mixed media.



COLORING ORDER:

- Sequential (Pages 1-50)
- Random (follow your intuition)
- Repeat favorites (print unlimited copies!)



TIME:

- No rules. 5 minutes or 2 hours—both valid.
- Stop when you need to. Return when you're ready.



JOURNAL PROMPTS:

- Completely optional.
- Use them, skip them, or create your own.



PRINTING:

- Print on thick paper or cardstock (prevents bleed-through)
- Print "Actual Size" (not "Fit to Page")
- You own this file—print as many copies as you want

TRAUMA-INFORMED TIPS:

- ✓ Take breaks when you need them
- ✓ Skip pages that feel triggering
- ✓ Color in a safe, comfortable space
- ✓ Have grounding tools nearby (tea, blanket, pet, music)
- ✓ It's okay if coloring brings up emotions—that's part of processing

*Your invisible pain is real.
This book sees it.*

*Take your time.
Be gentle with yourself.*

✦✦ You've got this.

— Abstract Emporium



Questions? Reach us at: abstractemporiumart@outlook.com
Visit: <https://abstractemporium.pages.dev/>

